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The Seven Branches

from Samantabhadra's "Aspiration to Good Actions" (Zangchö Mönlam)

THE SEVEN PRELIMINARIES FOR PURIFYING THE MIND

1. PROSTRATION

JINYÉ SU DAK CHOK CHÜ JIKTEN NA DÜ SUM SHEKPA MI YI SENGÉ KÜN
To all the buddhas, the lions of the human race, in all directions of the universe, through past and present and future:

DAK GI MALÜ DEDAK TAMCHÉ LA LÜ DANG NGAK YI DANGWÉ CHAK GYI O
To every single one of you, I bow in homage; devotion fills my body, speech and mind.

ZANGPO CHÖPÉ MÖNLAM TOB DAK GI GYALWA TAMCHÉ YI KYI NGÖNSUM DU
Through the power of this prayer, aspiring to Good Action, all the victorious ones appear, vivid here before my mind

ZHING GI DUL NYÉ LÜ RAB TÜPA YI GYALWA KÜN LA RABTU CHAKTSAL LO
And I multiply my body as many times as atoms in the universe, each one bowing in prostration to all the buddhas.

2. Offering

DUL CHIK TENG NA DUL NYÉ SANGYE NAM SANGYE SÉ KYI Ü NA ZHUKPA DAK
In every atom preside as many buddhas as there are atoms, and around them, all their bodhisattva heirs:

DETAR CHÖ KYI YING NAM MALÜPA TAMCHÉ GYALWA DAK GI GANGWAR MÖ
And so I imagine them filling completely the entire space of reality.

DEDAK NGAKPA MIZÉ GYATSO NAM YANG KYI YENLAK GYATSÖ DRA KÜN GYI
Saluting them with an endless ocean of praise, with the sounds of an ocean of different melodies

GYALWA KÜN GYI YÖNTEN RAB JÖ CHING DEWAR SHEKPA TAMCHÉ DAK GI TÖ
I sing of the buddhas' noble qualities, and praise all those who have gone to perfect bliss.

METOK DAMPA TRENGWA DAMPA DANG SILNYEN NAM DANG JUKPA DUK CHOK DANG
To every buddha, I make offerings: Of the loveliest flowers, of beautiful garlands,

MARMÉ CHOK DANG DUKPÖ DAMPA YI GYALWA DEDAK LA NI CHÖPAR GYI
Of music and perfumed ointments, the best of parasols, the brightest lamps and finest incense.

NAZA DAMPA NAM DANG DRI CHOK DANG CHEMA PURMA RIRAB NYAMPA DANG
To every buddha, I make offerings: Exquisite garments and the most fragrant scents,

KÖPA KHYEPAR PAKPÉ CHOK KÜN GYI GYALWA DEDAK LA NI CHÖPAR GYI
Powdered incense, heaped as high as Mount Meru, arranged in perfect symmetry.

CHÖPA GANG NAM LAMÉ GYA CHEWA DEDAK GYALWA TAMCHÉ LA YANG MÖ
Then the vast and unsurpassable offerings — inspired by my devotion to all the buddhas, and

ZANGPO CHÖ LA DEPÉ TOB DAK GI GYALWA KÜN LA CHAKTSAL CHÖPAR GYI
Moved by the power of my faith in Good Actions — I prostrate and offer to all you victorious ones.

3. Confession

DÖCHAK ZHEDANG TIMUK WANG GI NI LÜ DANG NGAK DANG DEZHIN YI KYI KYANG
Whatever negative acts I have committed, while driven by desire, hatred and ignorance,

DIKPA DAK GI GYIPA CHI CHIPA DEDAK TAMCHÉ DAK GI SOSOR SHAK
With my body, my speech and also with my mind, before you, I confess and purify each and every one.

4. Rejoicing

CHOK CHÜ GYALWA KÜN DANG SANGYE SÉ RANGGYAL NAM DANG LOB DANG MI LOB DANG
With a heart full of delight, I rejoice at all the merits of buddhas and bodhisattvas,

DROWA KÜN GYI SÖNAM GANGLA YANG DEDAK KÜN GYI JESU DAK YI RANG
Pratyekabuddhas, those in training and the arhats beyond training, and every living being, throughout the entire universe.

5. Imploring the Buddhas to Turn the Wheel of Dharma

GANG NAM CHOK CHÜ JIKTEN DRÖNMA NAM CHANGCHUB RIMPAR SANGYE MACHAK NYÉ
You who are like beacons of light shining through the worlds, who passed through the stages of enlightenment, to attain buddhahood, freedom from all attachment,

GÖNPO DEDAK DAK GI TAMCHÉ LA KHORLO LANAMEPAR KORWAR KUL
I exhort you: all of you protectors, turn the unsurpassable wheel of Dharma.

6. Requesting the Buddhas not to Enter Nirvāṇa

NYA NGEN DA TÖN GANG ZHÉ DEDAK LA DROWA KÜN LA PEN ZHING DEWÉ CHIR
Joining my palms together, I pray to you who intend to pass into nirvāṇa,

KALPA ZHING GI DUL NYÉ ZHUKPAR YANG DAK GI TALMO RAB JAR SOLWAR GYI
Remain, for aeons as many as the atoms in this world, and bring well-being and happiness to all living beings.

7. Dedication

CHAKTSALWA DANG CHÖ CHING SHAKPA DANG JESU YI RANG KUL ZHING SOLWA YI
What little virtue I have gathered through my homage, through offering, confession, and rejoicing,

GEWA CHUNGZÉ DAK GI CHI SAKPA TAMCHÉ DAK GI CHANGCHUB CHIR NGO O
Through exhortation and prayer — all of it I dedicate to the enlightenment of all beings!

Source: Lotsawa House, Rigpa Translations, 1996.
https://www.lotsawahouse.org/words-of-the-buddha/seven-branch-zangcho-monlam

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It must be reviewed before use for study and practice. May all beings benefit!